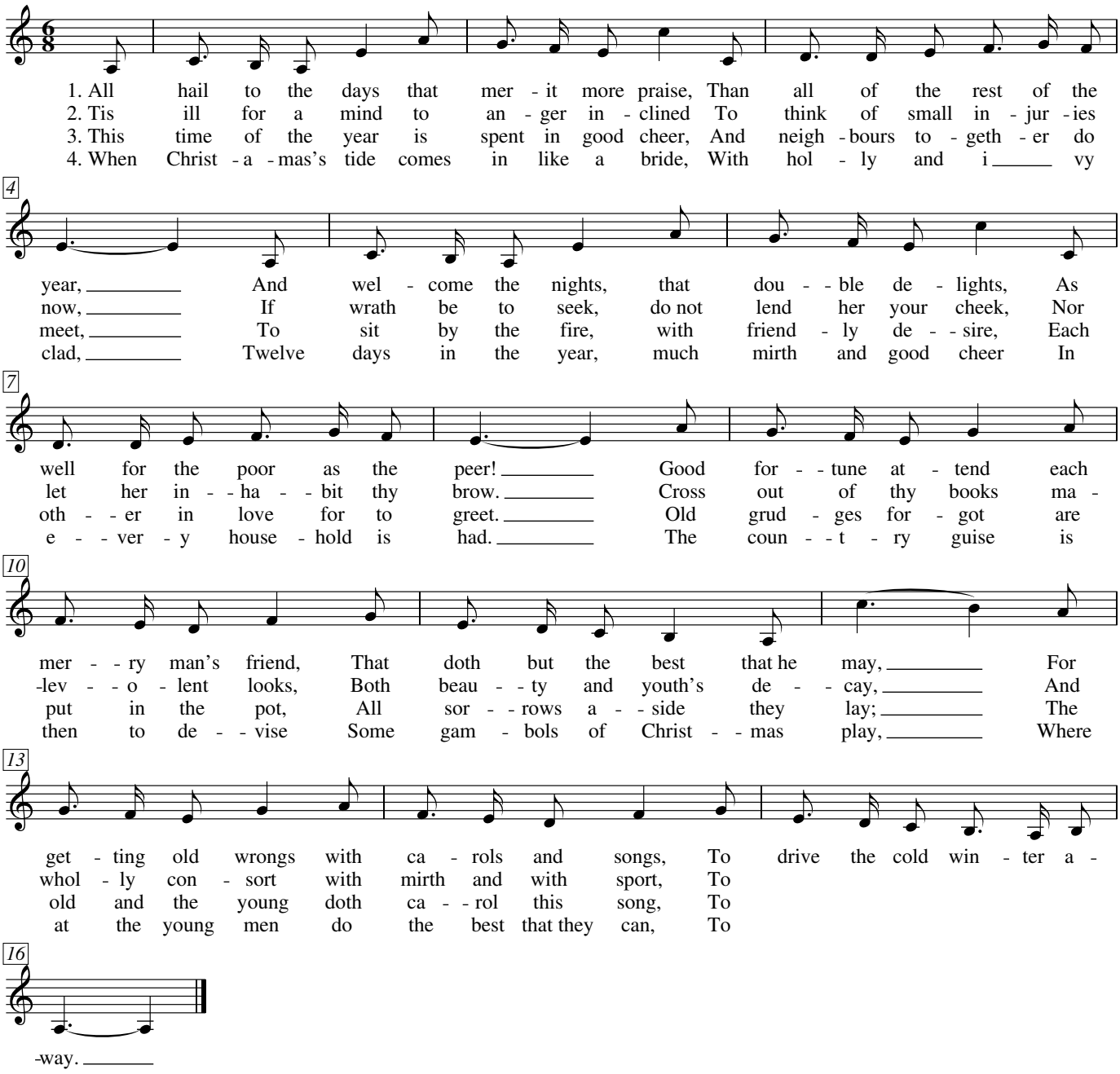
In Praise of Christmas
To Drive the Cold Winter Away

Words: Tom Durfey (1653-1723)
Tune: 18th Century



1. All hail to the days that merit more praise
   Than all of the rest of the year,
   And welcome the nights that double delights
   As well for the poor as the peer!
   Good fortune attend each merry man's friend
   That doth but the best that he may,
   Forgetting old wrongs with carols and songs
   To drive the cold winter away.

2. Tis ill for a mind to anger inclined
   To think of small injuries now,
   If wrath be to seek, do not lend her your cheek,
   Nor let her inhabit thy brow.
   Cross out of thy books malevolent looks,
   Both beauty and youth's decay,
   And wholly consort with mirth and with sport
   To drive the cold winter away.

3. This time of the year is spent in good cheer,
   And neighbours together do meet,
   To sit by the fire, with friendly desire,
   Each other in love for to greet.
   Old grudges forgot are put in the pot,
   All sorrows aside they lay;
   The old and the young doth carol this song,
   To drive the cold winter away.

4. When Christmas's tide comes in like a bride,
   With holly and ivy clad,
   Twelve days in the year, much mirth and good cheer
   In every household is had.
   The country guise is then to devise
   Some gambols of Christmas play,
   Whereat the young men do the best that they can
   To drive the cold winter away.